

The following outline is provided as an overview of and topical guide to World War I:

World War I – major war centred in Europe that began on 28 July 1914 and lasted until 11 November 1918. It involved all the world's great powers, which were assembled in two opposing alliances: the Allies (centred on the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia) and the Central Powers (originally centred on the Triple Alliance of Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy). More than 70 million military personnel, including 60 million Europeans, were mobilised in one of the largest wars in history. More than 9 million combatants were killed, largely because of great technological advances in firepower without corresponding advances in mobility. It was the sixth deadliest conflict in world history, subsequently paving the way for various political changes such as revolutions in the nations involved.

Nature of World War I

World War I can be described as all of the following:

War

Total war

World war

World War I was further characterized by the following types of warfare:

Aerial warfare

Armoured warfare

Asymmetric warfare (in some cases)

Attrition warfare

Chemical warfare

Ground warfare

Modern warfare

Naval warfare

Submarine warfare

Antisubmarine warfare

Unrestricted submarine warfare

Trench warfare

Causes of World War I

Long term influences leading to World War I

Cultural and strategic factors:

Imperialism

Militarism

Nationalism

Cult of the offensive – Considerations of the advantage of striking first.

Preventive war

Destabilizing of the European balance of power:

Balkanization

Tensions between Austria and Serbia

May Overthrow

Pig War

Bosnian crisis

Tensions between Russia and Austria

Campaign in and annexation of Bosnia by Austria-Hungary

First Balkan War

Second Balkan War

Tensions between France and Germany

Franco-Prussian War (1870–1871) – brought the establishment of a powerful and dynamic Germany, causing what was seen as a displacement or unbalancing of power

Tensions between the United Kingdom and Germany

Naval arms race between the United Kingdom and the German Empire

Tensions between Italy and Austria

Annexation of Bosnia by Austria-Hungary

Web of alliances:

Diplomatic history of World War I

The Central Powers

Dual Alliance (Germany and Austria-Hungary)

Triple Alliance (1882) (Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy)

The Allies

Franco-Russian Alliance (1894)

Entente Cordiale between France and the British

Anglo-Russian Entente of 1907

Triple Entente

Treaty of London, 1839, about the neutrality of Belgium

German Imperial War Council of 8 December 1912

Short term influences leading to World War I

Assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand of Austria

July Crisis

British entry into World War I

French entry into World War I

German entry into World War I

Japanese entry into World War I

Participants in World War I

World War I was fought between the Allies and the Central Powers.

The Central Powers (Triple Alliance)

German Empire

Austria-Hungary

Ottoman Empire

Bulgaria

The Allies (Triple Entente)

Main Allied countries

French Third Republic (including colonial forces)

United Kingdom (including colonial forces)

Russian Empire (until March 1917)

Russian Republic (March 1917 - November 1917)

Soviet Russia (November 1917 - March 1918)

Kingdom of Serbia

Kingdom of Italy (from May 1915) (including colonial forces)

Kingdom of Belgium (including colonial forces)

United States of America (after April 1917)

Other military allies

Other states that had military participation:

Kingdom of Montenegro

Empire of Japan

Portuguese Republic (March 1916 and after) (including Portuguese colonial forces)

Kingdom of Romania (August 1916 – May 1918, November 1918)

Kingdom of Greece (November 1916 for the Government of National Defence; June 1917 for the whole country)

Albania

Brazil (October 1917 and after)

Armenia (May 1918 and after)

Czechoslovakia – See Czechoslovak Legions

Nepal (soldiers served under the British Indian Army)

Kingdom of Siam

San Marino (June 1915 and after)

Sweden (June 1914-early 1916) (1918)

Nominal Allies

States that declared war, but had no military involvement:

Andorra

Bolivia (April 1917 and after)

China (August 1917 and after)

Costa Rica (May 1918 and after)

Cuba (April 1917 and after)

Ecuador (December 1917 and after)

Guatemala (April 1918 and after)

Liberia (August 1917 and after)

Haiti (July 1918 and after)

Honduras (July 1918 and after)

Nicaragua (May 1918 and after)

Panama (December 1917 and after)

Peru (October 1917 and after)

Uruguay (October 1917 and after)

Conduct of the war

Allied declarations of war

British propaganda during World War I

Convoys in World War I

German occupation of Luxembourg in World War I

Roosevelt's World War I volunteers

Strategic bombing during World War I

German strategic bombing during World War I

World War I conscription in Australia

World War I naval arms race

United States Navy operations during World War I

Military engagements of World War I

World War I theatres, fronts, and campaign

South Arabia during World War I

Western Front (World War I)

Eastern Front (World War I)

West Africa Campaign (World War I)

East African Campaign (World War I)

Italian Campaign (World War I)

Sinai and Palestine Campaign

Caucasus Campaign

Mesopotamian Campaign

Gallipoli Campaign

Attacks on North America during World War I

Naval campaigns of World War I

Battle of the Atlantic (1914-1918)

Adriatic Campaign of World War I

Naval operations in the Dardanelles Campaign

Blockade of Germany

World War I by country

Central Powers

Austria-Hungary during World War I

Hungary in World War I

Poland during World War I

Bulgaria during World War I

Germany during World War I

German East Africa during World War I

Poland during World War I

Ottoman Empire during World War I

Aliyah and yishuv during World War I

Armenia in World War I

Western Armenia

Armenians in the Ottoman Empire

Armenian notables deported from Constantinople in 1915

Armenian genocide

See also Armenian genocide recognition

Armenian resistance (1914–1918)

Administration for Western Armenia

Armenian irregular units

Armenian volunteer units

Armenian casualties during World War I

Seyfo

Greek genocide

Deportations of Kurds (1916–1934)

Prosecution of Ottoman war criminals after World War I

Allies

Main allies

Serbia during World War I

France during World War I

Summary

French foreign policy and the outbreak of the First World War

French Army in World War I

French villages destroyed in the First World War

Russia during World War I – food shortages in the major urban centres, and poor morale due to lost battles and heavy losses sustained, brought about civil unrest which led to the February Revolution, the abdication of the Tsar, and the end of the Russian Empire.

Russian Revolution (1917) – end of Imperial Russia

February Revolution –

Russian Provisional Government –

October Revolution – beginning of the Soviet Union

Poland during World War I

Finland during World War I

Grand Duchy of Finland

Finnish Declaration of Independence

Ukraine during World War I

British Empire during World War I

United Kingdom during World War I

Australia during World War I

Australian women during World War I

India in World War I

Canada during World War I

Newfoundland during World War I

New Zealand in World War I

South Africa in World War I

South African Overseas Expeditionary Force

Southern Rhodesia in World War I

Hong Kong during World War I

Italy in World War I

United States in World War I

Puerto Ricans in World War I

Other allies

Albania during World War I

Brazil during World War I

Czechoslovaks in World War I

Czechoslovak Legions

Greece during World War I

Japan during World War I

Montenegro during World War I

Nepal during World War I

Portugal during World War I

Romania during World War I

Siam during World War I

San Marino during World War I

Nominal allies

Andorra during World War I

Bolivia during World War I

China during World War I

Costa Rica during World War I

Cuba during World War I

Ecuador during World War I

Guatemala during World War I

Liberia during World War I

Haiti during World War I

Honduras during World War I

Panama during World War I

Peru during World War I

Uruguay during World War I

World War I impact on neutral countries

Norway in World War I

Espionage in Norway during World War I

Mexico in World War I

Ireland and World War I

Montserrat in World War I

Spain in World War I

Switzerland during the World Wars - Switzerland did declare a "state of siege".

Vietnam during World War I

Afghanistan – received a German diplomatic mission trying to convince it to act against the British in India

Argentina – Ally to US by treaty (see ABC countries for more information)

Bhutan

Chile – Ally to US by treaty (see ABC countries for more information)

Colombia

Denmark – Traded with both sides.

El Salvador

Ethiopian Empire – received a German diplomatic mission trying to convince it to act against the British in Africa

Liechtenstein – Had a customs and monetary union with Austria-Hungary.

Luxembourg – Never declared war on the Central Powers despite being invaded and occupied by Germany.

Mongolia

Mexico- Declined an alliance with Germany (see Zimmermann Telegram). An ally to the United

States by treaty (see ABC countries).

Netherlands – An ally of the United Kingdom by treaty. Traded with both sides.

Norway – Gave naval assistance to the United Kingdom.

Paraguay

Persia – Occupied by British and Russian troops.

Spain – Also treaty bound ally to the United Kingdom.

Sweden during World War I – Financially supported Germany.

Venezuela – Supplied the Allies with oil.

People in World War I

Leaders in World War I

Allied leaders of World War I

Leaders of the Central Powers of World War I

Military forces of World War I

Allies

List of formations of the United States Army during World War I

List of American aero squadrons

List of Australian divisions in World War I

List of British armies in World War I

List of British corps in World War I

List of British divisions in World War I

British Land Units of the First World War

Royal Flying Corps

List of Canadian divisions in World War I

List of French armies in World War I

List of Indian divisions in World War I

List of Italian armies in World War I

Imperial Russian Army formations and units (1914)

List of Russian armies in World War I

Royal Serbian Army

Central powers

Austro-Hungarian Armed Forces

Austro-Hungarian Army

Austro-Hungarian Navy

Austro-Hungarian Air Force

Military of the Ottoman Empire

Ottoman Army

Ottoman Navy

Ottoman Air Force

Imperial German Army

Field armies of Germany in World War I

List of Imperial German infantry regiments

Luftstreitkräfte

Schutztruppe

Imperial German Navy

Seebataillon

Technology during World War I

Equipment of World War I

Vehicles of World War I

List of military aircraft of Central Powers in WWI

List of military aircraft of Entente Powers in WWI

List of aircraft of the Royal Flying Corps

List of aircraft of the Royal Naval Air Service

List of military aircraft of Germany

Weapons of World War I

List of infantry weapons of World War I

British Army uniform and equipment in World War I

Chemical weapons in World War I

List of German weapons of World War I

Romanian military equipment of World War I

Common military awards

Russian Empire

Cross of St. George

Order of St. George

Order of Saint Vladimir

Order of Saint Anna

United States

United States service medals of the World Wars

American Campaign Medal

Air Medal

Asiatic-Pacific Campaign Medal

Bronze Star

Distinguished Flying Cross

European-African-Middle Eastern Campaign Medal

Medal of Honor

Silver Star

World War I Victory Medal

British Empire

Air Force Cross, from June 1918

Distinguished Flying Cross

Military Cross

Military Medal

Order of the Bath

Order of the British Empire

Victoria Cross

1914 Star

France and Belgium

Commemorative war medal

Croix de Guerre

Dardanelles campaign medal

Orient campaign medal

Imperial Germany

House Order of Hohenzollern

Iron Cross

Order of the Red Eagle

Pour le Mérite also known as the "Blue Max"

Kingdom of Serbia

Order of Karađorđe's Star

Austria-Hungary

Military Order of Maria Theresa

Military Merit Cross

War Crimes

The First World War saw many instances of war crimes being committed by both the Allied and

Central powers:

Genocides

Armenian genocide

Greek genocide

Massacres

Massacres of Albanians in World War I

Rape of Belgium

Siege of Tsingtao

Štip massacre

Surafend massacre

Surdulica massacre

Terrorism

List of German-sponsored acts of terrorism during World War I

Mistreatment of civilians

Raid on Scarborough, Hartlepool and Whitby

Turnip Winter

The end of World War I

Armistice of Salonica (September 29, 1918) - surrender of Bulgaria

Armistice of Mudros (October 30, 1918) – surrender of the Ottoman Empire

Armistice of Villa Giusti (November 3, 1918) – surrender of Austria-Hungary

Armistice with Germany (November 11, 1918) – surrender of Germany

Aftermath of World War I

World War I reparations

Dissolution of the Austro-Hungarian Empire into several successor states:

Czechoslovakia

Yugoslavia

First Republic of Austria

Hungarian Democratic Republic

Second Polish Republic

Cession by Austria-Hungary of Transylvania and Bukovina to Romania.

Cession by Austria-Hungary of the southern half of the County of Tyrol and Trieste to Italy

Establishment of the First Republic of Armenia

Further Balkanization

World War II

World War I was one of the main causes of World War II

World War I-related media

List of books about World War I

List of World War I films

World War I in literature

World War I in popular culture

Non-fiction

Germany's Aims in the First World War

Fiction

Fiction based on World War I

World War I remembered

World War I reenactment

WWI memorials

World War I Memorial (Berwick, Pennsylvania)

World War I Memorial (Atlantic City, New Jersey)

World War I Memorial (East Providence, Rhode Island)

WWI veterans

See also

Timeline of World War I

Opposition to World War I

Outline of war

Outline of World War II

Notes

References

Sources

Bade, Klaus J.; Brown, Allison (tr.) (2003). *Migration in European History. The making of Europe*. Oxford: Blackwell. ISBN 978-0-631-18939-8. OCLC 52695573. (translated from the German)

Keegan, John (1998). *The First World War*. Hutchinson. ISBN 978-0-09-180178-6.

Willmott, H.P. (2003). *World War I*. Dorling Kindersley. ISBN 978-0-7894-9627-0. OCLC 52541937.

Further reading

Bond, Brian. "The First World War" in C. L. Mowat, ed. *The New Cambridge Modern History: Vol. XII: The Shifting Balance of World Forces 1898-1945* (2nd ed. 1968) online pp 171–208.

External links

The War to End All Wars on BBC

WWI Service Questionnaires at Gettysburg College

A multimedia history of World War I

The Heritage of the Great War, Netherlands

Collection of World War I Color Photographs

The Commonwealth War Graves Commission

Royal Engineers Museum Royal Engineers and the First World War

World War I : Soldiers Remembered Presented by the Washington State Library and

Washington State Archives

The World War I Document Archive Wiki